

Landlord Compliance Checklist — South Australia

The obligations every rental provider must meet under the 2024–2026 reforms.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice. Confirm current requirements with Consumer and Business Services (CBS) SA before relying on this checklist alone.

Section 1 — Using the Correct Prescribed Forms

- ☐ [] **Use current prescribed forms** — these changed on 1 July 2024 and again on 1 September 2025 under the Residential Tenancies Regulations 2025. Forms from before these dates may no longer be compliant.
- ☐ [] **Use the correct termination form for your specific ground** — SA has six landlord termination forms (Forms 5–10), and using the wrong one for your situation can invalidate the notice entirely.

Section 2 — Ending a Tenancy

- ☐ [] **Know no-grounds terminations were abolished from 1 July 2024.** Every termination notice must state a prescribed reason.
- ☐ [] **Know the notice period rules for fixed-term tenancies.** Outside specific grounds (breach under Form 5, or drug contamination under Form 6), a fixed-term tenancy can generally only be terminated at the end of its term, with at least **60 days' notice** on a prescribed ground.
- ☐ [] **Know about the mandatory evidence requirement.** For possession-based grounds (demolition, renovation, family occupation, sale, sales agency), you need written evidence approved by the Commissioner — a stated intention alone isn't sufficient.
- ☐ [] **Understand the 6-month re-letting restriction.** After terminating on any of the 5 possession-based grounds, you generally cannot re-let the property for 6 months, whether the tenancy was periodic or fixed-term, unless SACAT grants specific consent.
- ☐ [] **Follow the correct rent arrears process.** A 7-day remedy period generally applies following a Form 5 breach notice — if the tenant pays within that window, the notice has no further effect.

Section 3 — Rent and Bonds

- ☐ [] **Increase rent no more than once every 12 months**, with at least 60 days' written notice.
- ☐ [] **Lodge bonds within the required deadline** — 2 weeks if you're self-managing, 4 weeks if you're using a registered agent.
- ☐ [] **Never claim fair wear and tear against a bond.**
- ☐ [] **Meet the stricter evidence requirements** for any bond claim you make, introduced as part of the 2024 reforms.

Section 4 — Pets

- ☐ [] **Understand pets are now permitted subject to your approval and reasonable conditions** — since 1 July 2024, you can no longer issue a blanket refusal; you can require reasonable conditions (e.g. the pet staying outside, or professional carpet cleaning at lease end) but must genuinely consider requests.

Section 5 — Penalties and Disputes

- ☐ [] **Understand SACAT's role** in resolving tenancy disputes, including possession, bond, and compensation matters.
- ☐ [] **Know about the internal review limit for money orders.** Since the 2024 reforms, a party generally cannot seek internal review of a SACAT order requiring payment of money except in exceptional circumstances — designed to prevent payment delays, but meaning you should treat your SACAT hearing as your primary opportunity to present your case.
- ☐ [] **Keep thorough records** — rent payments, repair requests and responses, condition reports, and all tenant communications.

Quick Reference — SA Landlord Compliance Calendar

OBLIGATION	DETAIL
Current prescribed forms	Updated 1 September 2025
No-grounds evictions	Abolished since 1 July 2024
Rent increase	Once per 12 months, 60 days' notice
Possession-ground re-letting ban	6 months
Bond lodgement	2 weeks (self-managing) / 4 weeks (agent)
Pets	Permitted subject to reasonable conditions

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